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Weber et al.

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(54) **DRYING APPARATUS**

(71) Applicants: **Cindi Weber**, Boaz, AL (US); **James Weber**, Boaz, AL (US)

(72) Inventors: **Cindi Weber**, Boaz, AL (US); **James Weber**, Boaz, AL (US)

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A47K 10/12 (2006.01)
A47K 10/02 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **A47K 10/02** (2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
CPC A47K 10/02
USPC 34/95
See application file for complete search history.

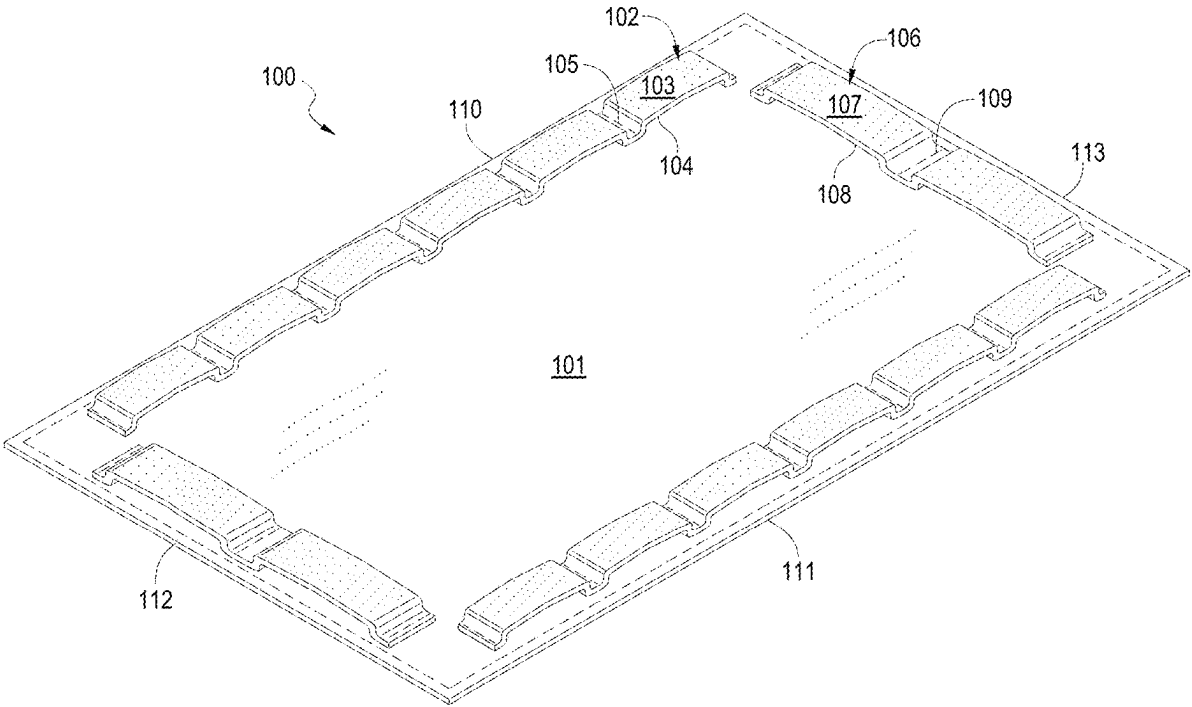
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Primary Examiner — John P McCormack
(74) *Attorney, Agent, or Firm* — HULSEY P.C.

(57) **ABSTRACT**
A drying apparatus of the present disclosure has a drying towel having a first face and a second face. The drying apparatus also has a first handle secured to the first face of the drying towel at or near an end of the drying towel so that a caregiver can grasp the drying towel to dry a disabled person with the second face.

3 Claims, 3 Drawing Sheets



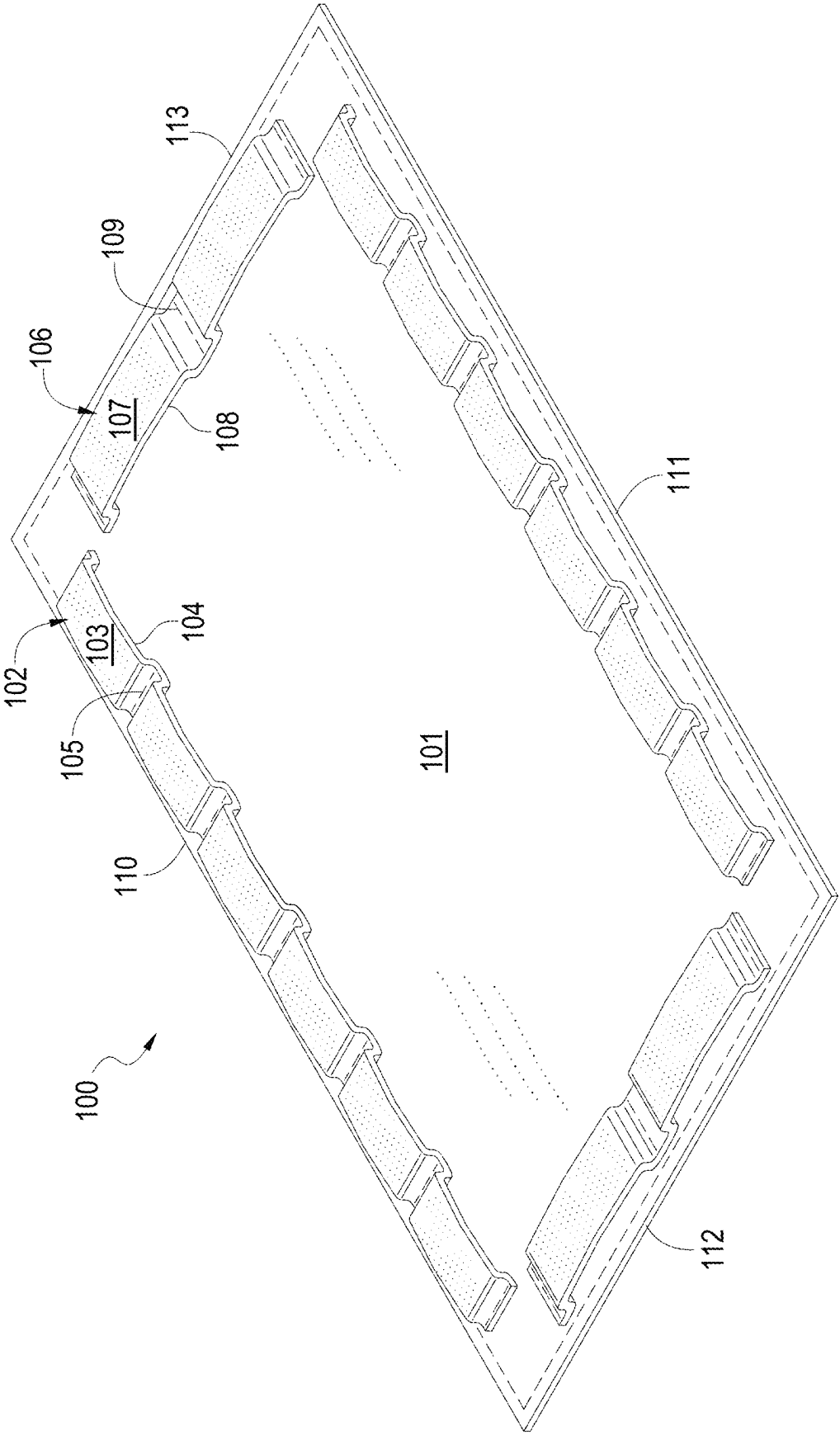
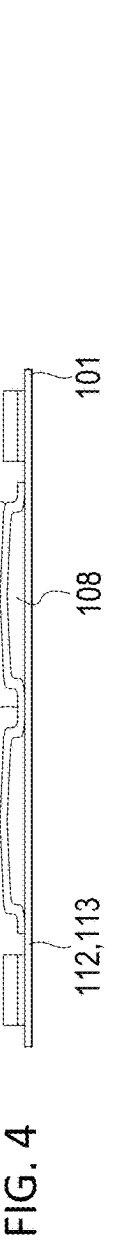
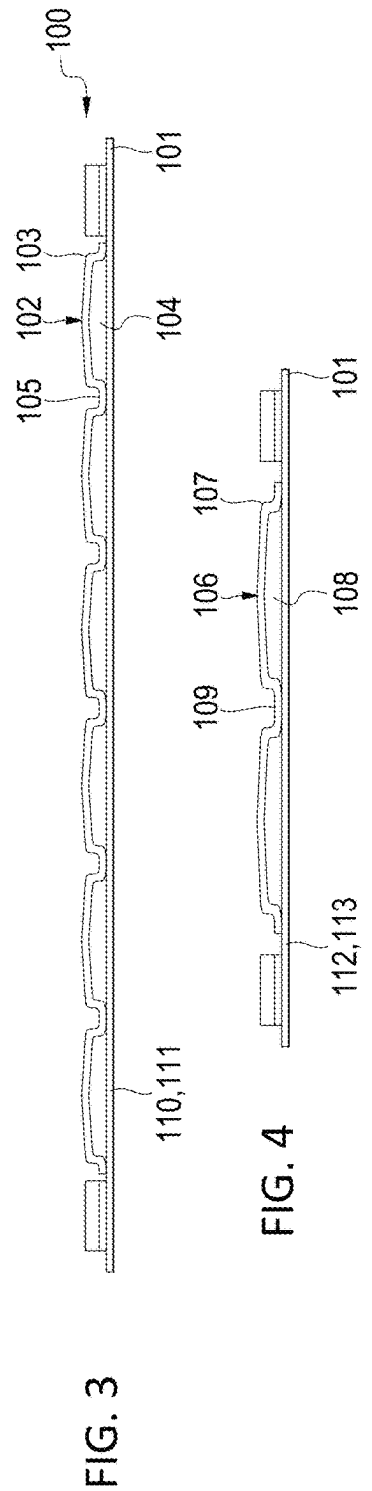
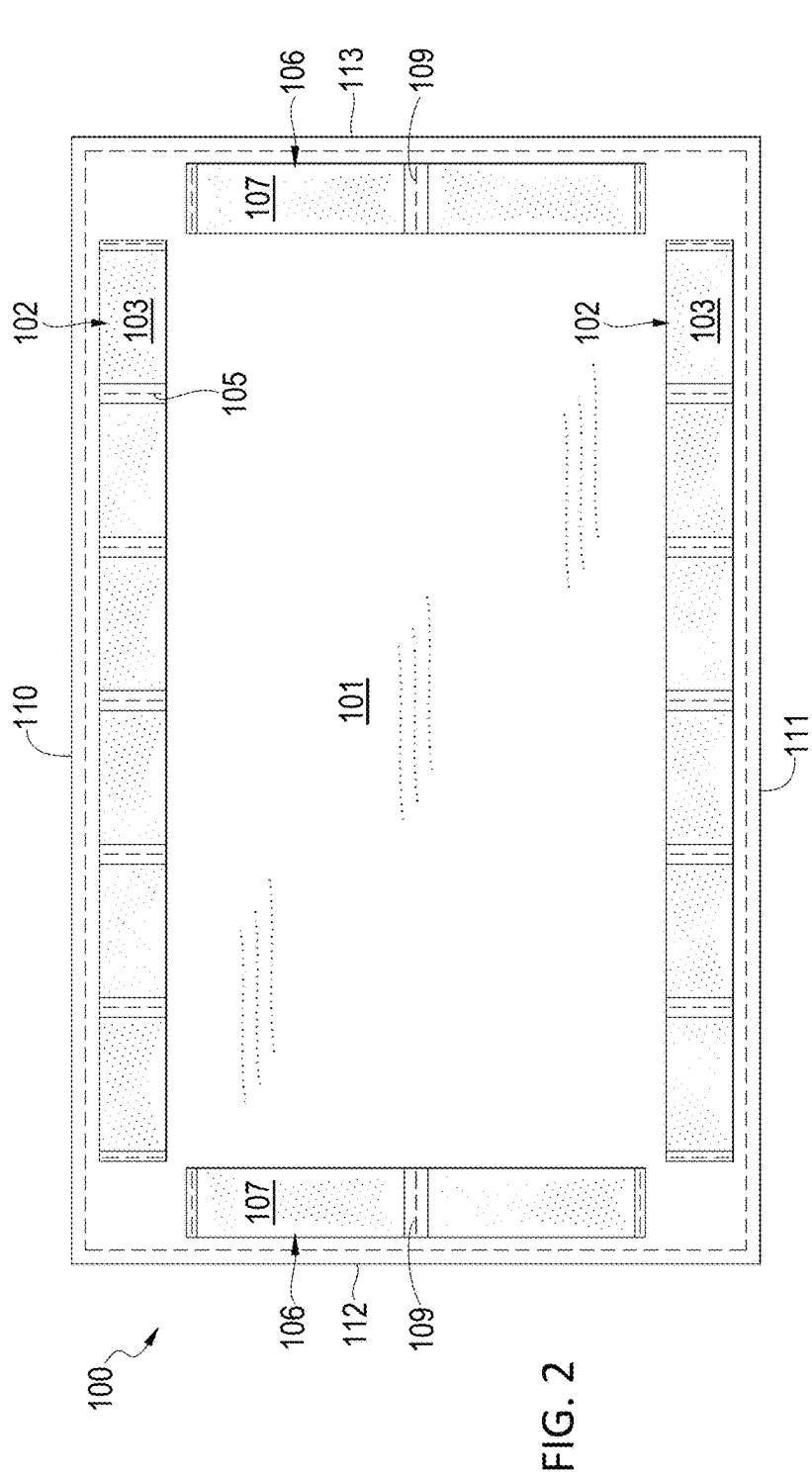


FIG. 1



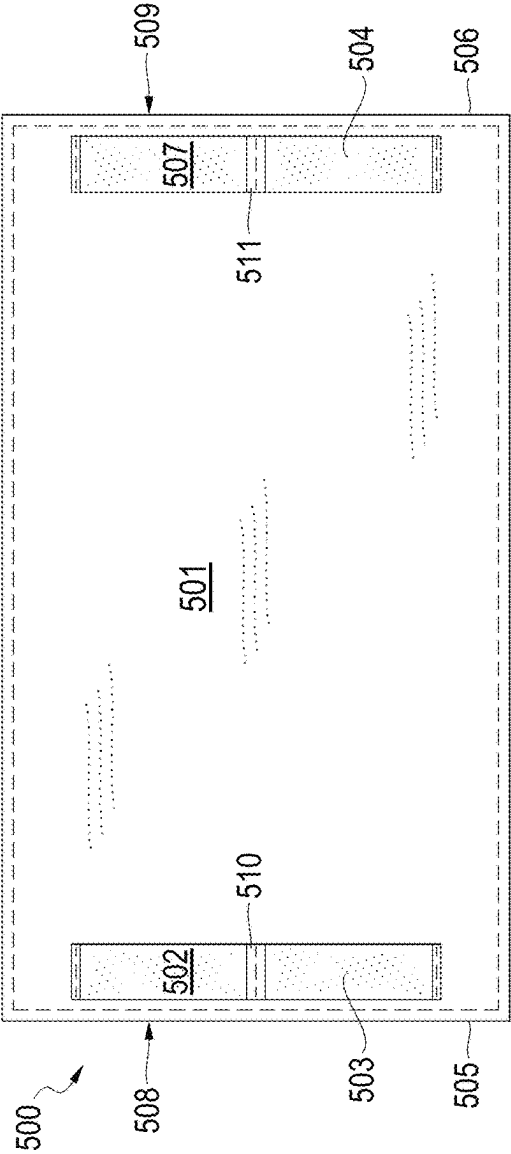


FIG. 5

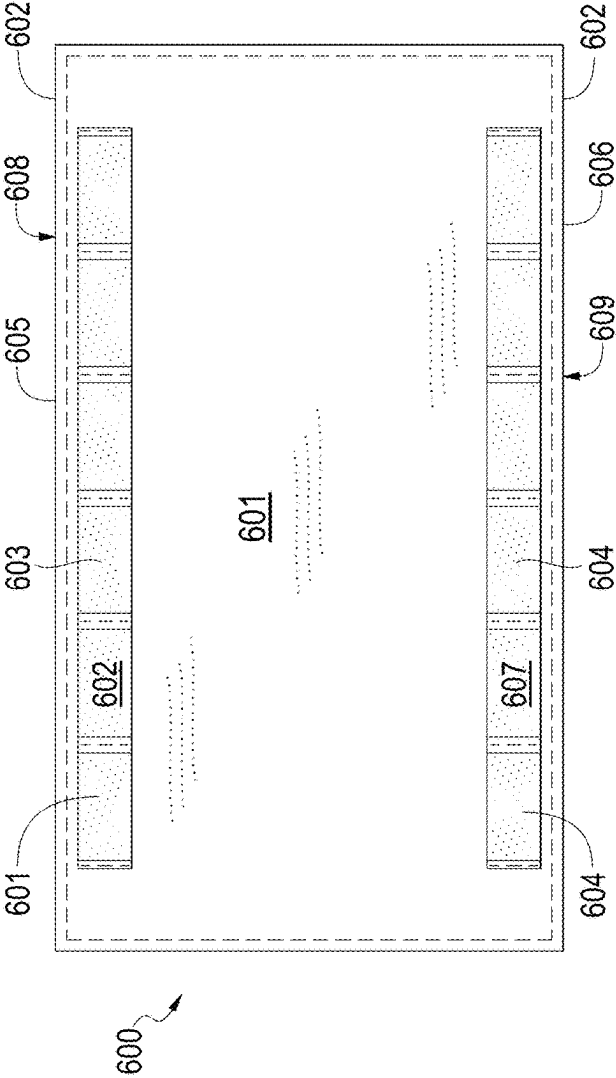


FIG. 6

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DRYING APPARATUS

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

This application is a continuation-in-part of and claims priority to Nonprovisional patent application Ser. No. 18/208,180 entitled Drying Apparatus filed on Jun. 9, 2023, which is incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

Caregivers often have a challenging time giving disabled individuals baths or showers. In this regard, the caregiver must position the person differently to ensure that each part of the disabled person's body is dried. In some instances, the caregiver might find it necessary to hold the disabled person with one hand and towel dry with the other hand. This is difficult to do with a conventional towel.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING FIGURES

FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a drying towel in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

FIG. 2 is a face view of the drying towel as shown in FIG. 1.

FIG. 3 is a long side view of the drying towel as shown in FIG. 1.

FIG. 4 is a short side view of the drying towel as shown in FIG. 1.

FIG. 5 is a face view of a drying towel having handles on a short end of the drying towel in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure.

FIG. 6 is a face view of a drying towel having handles on a long end of the drying towel in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure.

DESCRIPTION

The present disclosure relates to a drying towel in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The exemplary drying towel is rectangular. On one face of the towel is a plurality of handles. Note that the rectangular shape of the towel is for exemplary purposes only. A drying towel in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure may be other geometric shapes in other embodiments, e.g., circular, square, triangular, etc. Note that the drying towel can be any size known in the art or future-developed, e.g., 16"×27", 16"×30", 27"×52", 30"×60", or 35"×60".

FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an exemplary drying towel 100 in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The exemplary towel 100 is rectangular. However, the exemplary towel 100 may be other geometric shapes in other embodiments, e.g., circular, square, triangular, etc. Further, the drying towel may be many sizes, including but not limited to 16"×27", 16"×30", 27"×52", 30"×60", or 35"×60".

The exemplary drying towel 100 has long parallel edges 110 and 111. Further, the exemplary drying towel 100 has short parallel edges 112 and 113.

Secured to the drying towel 100 is a plurality of handles 103 and 107. The handles 103 and 107 are secured to a face 101 of the drying towel 100 at or near the edges 110 and 111 and/or 112 and 113, respectively. Securing the handles 103 and 107 at or near the edges 110 and 111 and/or 112 and 113

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allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel 100 for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles 103 and 107 to maintain a grasp on the drying towel 100 and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel 100 opposite the face 101 to which the handles 103 and 107 are secured.

The exemplary drying towel 100 comprises a long rectangular swath of fabric 102 along the long edge 110 of the drying towel 100. The long rectangular swath of fabric 102 is secured to the face 101 of drying towel at regular intervals along the long rectangular swath of fabric 102 via stitches 105.

The stitches 105 form the handle 103. The handle 103 forms an opening 104 in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

Note that the exemplary drying towel 100 comprising the long swath of fabric 102 is merely exemplary. The handles 103 may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle 103 is secured separately to the face 101 of the drying towel 100. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle 103 may be secured to the face 101 of the drying towel 100 via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles 103 in other embodiments.

The exemplary drying towel 100 further comprises a short rectangular swath of fabric 106 along the short edge 113 of the drying towel 100. The short rectangular swath of fabric 106 is secured to the face 101 of drying towel at regular intervals along the short rectangular swath of fabric 106 via stitches 109.

The stitches 109 form the handle 107. The handle 107 forms an opening 108 in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

Note that the exemplary drying towel 100 comprising the short swath of fabric 106 is merely exemplary. The handle 107 may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle 107 is secured separately to the face 101 of the drying towel 100. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle 107 may be secured to the face 101 of the drying towel 100 via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles 107 in other embodiments.

FIG. 2 is a top plan view of the exemplary drying towel 100 in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The drying towel 100 comprises the long edges 110 and 111 and the short edges 112 and 113.

The handles 103 and 107 are secured to the face 101 of the drying towel 100 at or near the edges 110 and 111 and/or 112 and 113, respectively. Securing the handles 103 and 107 at or near the edges 110 and 111 and/or 112 and 113 allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel 100 for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles 103 and 107 to maintain a grasp on the drying towel 100 and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel 100 opposite the face 101 to which the handles 103 and 107 are secured.

The exemplary drying towel 100 comprises the long rectangular swath of fabric 102 along the long edge 111 of the drying towel 100. The long rectangular swath of fabric 102 is secured to the face 101 of drying towel 100 at regular intervals along the long rectangular swath of fabric 102 via stitches 105 (FIG. 1).

The stitches 105 form the handle 103. The handle 103 forms the opening 104 (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

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The exemplary drying towel **100** comprises the short rectangular swath of fabric **106** along the long edge **113** of the drying towel **100**. The short rectangular swath of fabric **106** is secured to the face **101** of drying towel **100** at regular intervals along the short rectangular swath of fabric **106** via stitches **109**.

The stiches **109** form the handle **107**. The handle **107** forms the opening **108** (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

FIG. 3 is a side view of a long side edge **110** or **111** of the drying towel **100**. The drying towel **100** comprises the swath of fabric **102** at or near the edge **110** or **111** of the drying towel **100**. The swath of fabric **102** is secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via a plurality of stiches **105** at regular intervals.

The stiches **105** form the handle **103**. The handle **103** forms the opening **104**. The opening **104** receives a caregiver's hand so that the caregiver can easily grasp the drying towel **100** when drying a disabled person (not shown).

As noted above, the drying towel **100** comprising the long swath of fabric **106** is merely exemplary. The handle **107** may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle **107** is secured separately to the face **101** of the drying towel **100**. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle **103** may be secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles **107** in other embodiments.

FIG. 4 is a side view of a short side edge **112** or **113** of the drying towel **100**. The drying towel **100** comprises the swath of fabric **106** at or near the edge **112** and/or **113** of the drying towel **100**. The swath of fabric **106** is secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via the plurality of stiches **109** at regular intervals.

The stiches **109** form the handle **107**. The handle **107** forms the opening **108**. The opening **108** receives a caregiver's hand so that the caregiver can easily grasp the drying towel **100** when drying a disabled person (not shown).

As noted above, the drying towel **100** comprising the short swath of fabric **106** is merely exemplary. The handle **107** may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle **107** is secured separately to the face **101** of the drying towel **100**. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle **103** may be secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles **107** in other embodiments. Also note that handles **103** and **107** are shown along the long edges **110** and **111** and the short edges **112** and **113**. While handles **103** and **107** are shown along all four edges **110**, **111**, **112**, and **113**, handles **103** and **107** may be secured along only one edge, two edges, or three edges in other embodiments.

FIG. 5 is a top view of another embodiment of an exemplary towel **500** in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. In such an embodiment, the towel **500** comprises handles **503** and **504** at each short end of the towel **500**. The handles **503** and **504** are secured to the face **501** of the drying towel **500** at or near the edges **505** and **506**, respectively. Securing the handles **503** and **504** at or near the

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edges **505** and **506** allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel **500** for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles **503** and **504** to maintain a grasp on the drying towel **500** and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel **500** opposite the face **501** to which the handles **503** and **504** are secured.

In one embodiment, the exemplary drying towel **500** comprises rectangular swaths of fabric **502** and **507** along the edges **505** and **504**, respectively, of the drying towel **500**. The rectangular swaths of fabric **502** and **507** are secured to the face **501** of drying towel **500** at regular intervals along the short ends **508** and **509** of the face **501** via stitches **510** and **511**, respectively.

The stiches **510** and **511** form the handles **503** and **504**. The handles **503** and **504** form openings like those openings **104** (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

FIG. 6 is a top view of another embodiment of an exemplary towel **600** in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. In such an embodiment, the towel **600** comprises handles **603** and **604** at the long ends **608** and **609** of the towel **600**. The handles **603** and **604** are secured to the face **601** of the drying towel **600** at or near the edges **605** and **606**, respectively. Securing the handles **603** and **604** at or near the edges **608** and **609** allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel **600** for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles **603** and **604** to maintain a grasp on the drying towel **600** and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel **600** opposite the face **601** to which the handles **603** and **604** are secured.

In one embodiment, the exemplary drying towel **600** comprises long rectangular swaths of fabric **602** and **607** along the long edges **605** and **606**, respectively, of the drying towel **600**. The long rectangular swaths of fabric **602** and **607** are secured to the face **601** of drying towel **600** at regular intervals along the long ends **608** and **609** of the face **601** via stitches **610** and **611**.

The stiches **610** and **611** form the handles **603** and **604**. The handles **603** and **604** form openings like those openings **104** (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

What we claim is:

1. A drying apparatus, comprising:

a drying towel having a first face and a second face opposite the first face; and

a plurality of handles positioned on each end of the first face, wherein each handle of the plurality of handles extending from and being secured to the first face of the drying towel, wherein each handle defines an opening, with the first face of the drying towel, through which a caregiver can insert a hand to grasp the drying towel, thereby allowing the second face to dry a disabled person.

2. The drying apparatus of claim 1, wherein the plurality of handles is secured to the first face at regular intervals via stitches.

3. The drying apparatus of claim 1, wherein each handle comprises a swath of fabric secured to the first face via stitches.

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